[Metric]
A-A-2909
September 29, 1995
Superseding
SS-P-186E
October 24, 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
PENCIL, MECHANICAL FOR 3.05MM LEADS
(CHINA MARKING)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description by all federal agencies and will replace Federal Specification **SS-P-186E Type I (c) Class 1.**

1. **Scope:** This commercial item description covers china marking mechanical pencils for general writing purposes.

2. **Salient Characteristics:**

2.1 Mechanical pencils shall consist of a round plastic barrel which contains a wax lead that propels, repels, and expels leads as specified, and a metal pocket clip.

2.2 Mechanical pencils shall operate by twist action to propel, repel, and expel lead from the point, and shall operate smoothly and easily, without binding, bending, breaking or other malfunction.

2.3 The length and diameter of the wax lead shall conform to commercial item description A-A-2910 (Leads, China Marking Colored-Wax) paragraph 2.3 and the barrel colors shall be the same as the wax lead it contains.

2.4 The twist action mechanism and point shall hold the lead firmly, without breaking, so that the lead does not turn or slip into or out of the pencil. The pencil shall be capable of dispensing the specified lead size.

2.5 The pencils shall be furnished in the following colors; Black, Red, Yellow, Orange or as specified in paragraph 6.2.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7520

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2.6 The pencils shall be capable of writing on the following glossy-surface materials: glass, aluminum, including aluminum foil; cellophane and cellulose acetate adhesive tape, and glazed white porcelain.

2.7 Manufacturer's name, trademark, or current commercial marking shall be exhibited on the pencil. Placement of these markings shall be at the option of the manufacturer, provided they are prominently legible.

2.8 Workmanship: Mechanical pencils shall conform to normal commercial practice. Pencils, and leads shall be suitable for the purposes intended. Pencils, and leads shall be securely assembled so that parts do not become loose or displaced and shall be free from defects or imperfections which may adversely affect appearance or serviceability.

3. Regulatory Requirements:

The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

4. Quality Assurance Requirements:

4.1 Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and therefore as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.2 Examination and Testing:

4.2.1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC Techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. If used, objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

4.2.2 End item inspection/testing may be used by the offeror or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. In process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing.

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4.2.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection/test shall be required. The sample unit shall be one pencil. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

4.2.4 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level for visual & dimensional examination shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. For performance testing, the level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 2.5 percent defective. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

4.3 Performance Testing:

4.3.1 Breaking Strength. Wax lead and mechanical pencil in accordance with this commercial item description, shall be placed in a rigid holding block set to maintain a constant angle of 45° - 50° between the pencil and the platform. The pencil shall extend beyond the underside of the block 31.75 mm to 38.10 mm (1 1/4 to 1 1/2 inches), measured along the pencil to the end of the prepared end. The scale platform shall be smooth and shall offer no resistance to the point moving across its surface. Pressure shall be applied by pushing the rod, which holds the block, down gradually and uniformly in order to avoid variations and shock. Readings shall be taken at the instant of breaking, provided the breaking point is definite. A slow, mushy deformation or crumbling shall be considered as a break with the reading to be taken as nearly as possible to the point where this type of failure begins. The breaking strength shall be based on the average of all tests made. Not less than three pencils of a color of lead be used and each pencil shall be subjected to not less than four tests. All leads being tested and all pencils being used as holding devices shall be held at a temperature of not less than 23° + 1.1°C (73.5° + 2°F) relative humidity 50 + 4%, for a minimum of 12 hours preceding the test.

5. Packaging:

5.1 Preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

6. Notes:

6.1 Applicable Documents. Issues of the following documents in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

6.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

6.1.2 Application for copies of ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 can be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control. PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

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6.2 Ordering Information: Purchasers shall select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents.

A. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
B. Purchasers shall specify the lead color. If (other) color is required, the color shall be specified and degree of hardness.
C. Purchasers shall specify arrangement for inspection and facilities if other than specified.
D. Purchasers shall specify packaging, packing, and any special marking for shipment.
E. Purchasers shall specify identification marking, if other than required.
F. Purchasers shall specify if bar coding is not required.
G. Purchasers shall specify palletization, if required.

6.3 National Stock Number Listing:

Pencil, Mechanical
(China, Marking)

7520-00-223-6672
7520-00-223-6673
7520-00-223-6675

MILITARY INTERESTS:
NONE: DoD has waived coordination on revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY
GSA-FSS

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